LET THERE BE NOISE

JADAVPUR UNIVERSITY UNREST, 2014

Kolkata

46TH ANNIVERSARY

YOUTH UPRISINGS

The flashpoint came on September 17, when university authorities allowed police to enter the campus and baton-charge students

One of the most prominent students' movements in recent years began at Jadavpur University in Kolkata in early September 2014, following a case of sexual assault that was handled in a lackadaisical manner by university authorities. A major flashpoint was a sit-in demonstration at Jadavpur in mid-September. After a heated altercation between students and university authorities, including the then vice-chancellor, the administration called the police. On September 17, police personnel entered the campus and lathi-charged students, even arresting many on false charges.

The police brutality resulted in a surge of public sympathy, with tens of thousands taking to the streets. On September 20, representatives of a huge protest march in Kolkata met West Bengal Governor Keshari Nath Tripathi. The slogan of the protest—'*Hok Kolorob*', meaning "let there be noise"—went viral on social media, gaining support from across the country and even abroad. In January 2015, after months of sustained protest, the Trinamool Congress government announced the resignation of Jadavpur University's vice chancellor. ■

– Romita Datta

SECURITY CODE Institutional failure to protect students should result in leadership changes, not repression



GETTY IMAGES

◀Congress workers brave water cannons in Delhi as they protest then HRD minister Smriti Irani's statement on Vemula's suicide

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CAMPAIGN FOR DALIT RIGHTS, 2016

Hyderabad